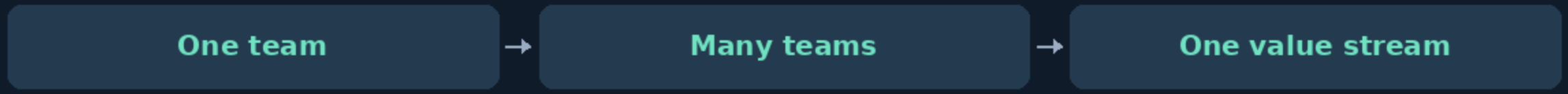
Why SAFe exists

1. Agile works for one team
2. Enterprises need coordinated value streams
3. SAFe = Scaled Agile Framework



SAFe today: Core and AI-Native

1. Homepage distinguishes Core SAFe and AI-Native SAFe
2. AI-Native SAFe released 2026
3. Framework evolves; check access dates



The ART and the Planning Interval

1. Agile Release Train: long-lived team of teams
2. Planning Interval: 8-12 week timebox
3. PI Planning aligns teams; value flows on demand

Teams → ART → PI plan → Release on demand

Four configurations (SAFe 6.0 context)

1. Essential: the ART foundation
2. Large Solution: big systems, no portfolio layer
3. Portfolio / Full: strategy and funding at scale

Essential → Large Solution → Portfolio → Full

What the evidence does (and doesn't) say

1. Adoption surveys exist but vary in method
2. Vendor research is directional, not independent
3. No framework guarantees outcomes



Key takeaways

1. Start with Essential; add layers on need
2. Plan synchronously; release on demand
3. Educational only - not certification

Start simple → Inspect → Adapt